



Ocelot
(*Leopardus pardalis*)
Body length: up to
3 ft 3 in (1 m)
Tail: up to 16 in (41 cm)

Spotted cat

The beautiful ocelot is rarely seen, but each cat has a different pattern of markings on its coat. The ocelot is an excellent climber and swimmer. It comes out at night to hunt for birds, snakes, and small mammals.

Rare animal

A relative of the hedgehog, the Cuban solenodon is a rare animal found only in Cuba. It is in danger of becoming extinct because it reproduces slowly, and is also threatened by new species, such as the mongoose, brought to Cuba by humans.



Cuban solenodon (*Atopogale cubana*)
Body length: up to 14 in (36 cm)
Tail: up to 7.5 in (19 cm)



Resplendent quetzal
(*Pharomachrus mocinno*)
Body length: up to
41 in (105 cm)
Tail: up to 2 ft (60 cm)

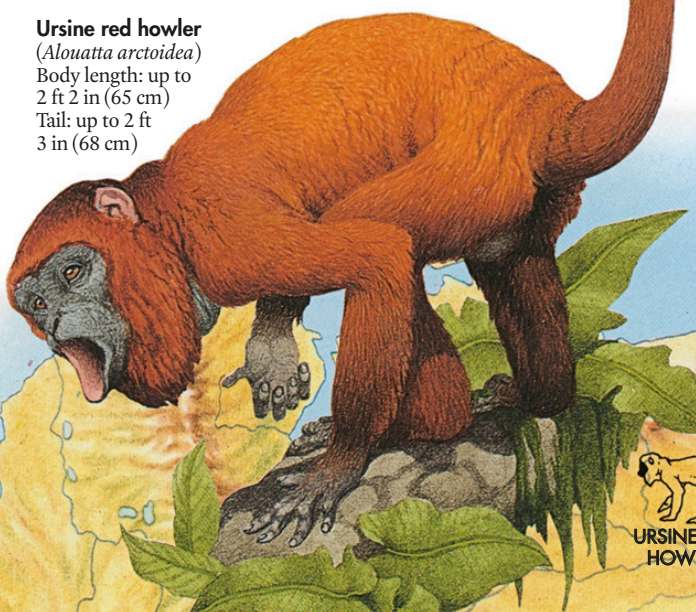
Sacred bird

The ancient peoples of Central America once worshipped the brilliantly colored quetzal as the god of the air. They used the male bird's long tail feathers in religious ceremonies. The male sheds his tail feathers after each breeding season and grows new ones the following year.

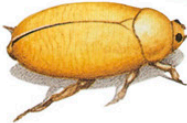
Loudest animal

Male howler monkeys are the noisiest land animals in the world. They shout and roar at rival monkeys to tell them to keep out of their territory. The howler has a large voice box that enables it to roar so loudly, it can be heard up to 2 miles (3 km) away.

Ursine red howler
(*Alouatta arctoidea*)
Body length: up to
2 ft 2 in (65 cm)
Tail: up to 2 ft
3 in (68 cm)



Golden scarab beetle (*Chrysina resplendens*)
Length: up to
1.4 in (3.6 cm)



Shiny wings

The metallic sheen on the wing cases of the golden beetle acts as a form of camouflage. The cases reflect the light and make the beetle's outline harder to see.



Many of the islands were formed by underwater volcanoes. There are still active volcanoes in the region.



URSINE RED HOWLER

GUADELOUPE

MARTINIQUE

BARBADOS



St. Vincent Amazon
(*Amazona guildingii*)
Length: up to
18 in (46 cm)
Wingspan: 2 ft (63 cm)

Handy feet

This parrot lives only on the Caribbean island of St. Vincent. It has unusual feet, with two toes pointing forward and two pointing backward. This gives it a powerful grip on branches and allows it to use its feet like hands. Each parrot is either right- or left-footed.



SCARLET IBIS

TRINIDAD

Scarlet ibis
(*Eudocimus ruber*)
Length: up to 2 ft 4 in (71 cm)
Wingspan: up to 3 ft 5 in (1.05 m)

Curved bill

The scarlet ibis has a long, curved bill, which it uses to probe in soft mud for insects, frogs, crustaceans, and fish. Ibises feed and nest in flocks. They often nest in trees or in areas surrounded by water, where they are safer from enemies. The island of Trinidad is famous for its nesting colonies.



S O U T H A M E R I C A



Many of the Caribbean islands have beautiful sandy beaches and are popular vacation resorts.

